

Coin Clarity

Turn Wave Coins from a transaction record into a reason to come back.

THIRD WAVE COFFEE · MOBILE LOYALTY

A 10-page product case study proposing a clearer, more trustworthy Wave Coins experience for app and in-store members.

PM DECISION

The next loyalty move is not another reward. It is a reliable answer to one practical question:

“What can I use right now, and what will happen if I do?”

Problem → Insight → Product bet → Outcome

10%

earn rate on eligible invoice value
FACT · before taxes

INR 1

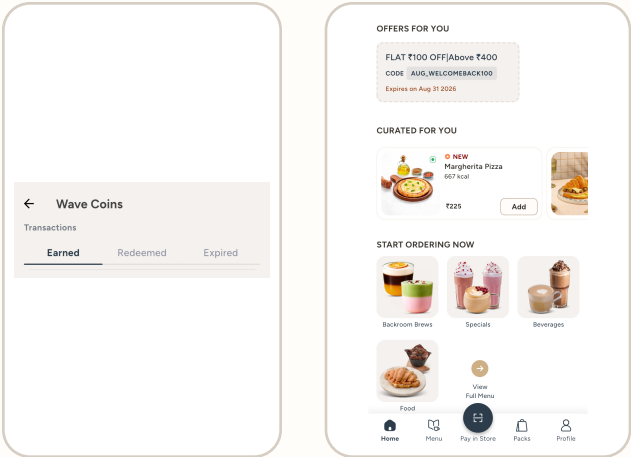
value of one Wave Coin
FACT · discount value

INR 50–INR 200

current redemption range
FACT · per transaction

AT A GLANCE

USER	App or in-store member with Wave Coins
PRODUCT AREA	Loyalty, wallet, checkout and QR scan
PRIMARY KPI	30-day redemption rate among eligible earners
STAGE	Illustrative discovery → MVP proposal
CONSTRAINT	Do not alter current value or redemption policy in V1



PRODUCT EVIDENCE

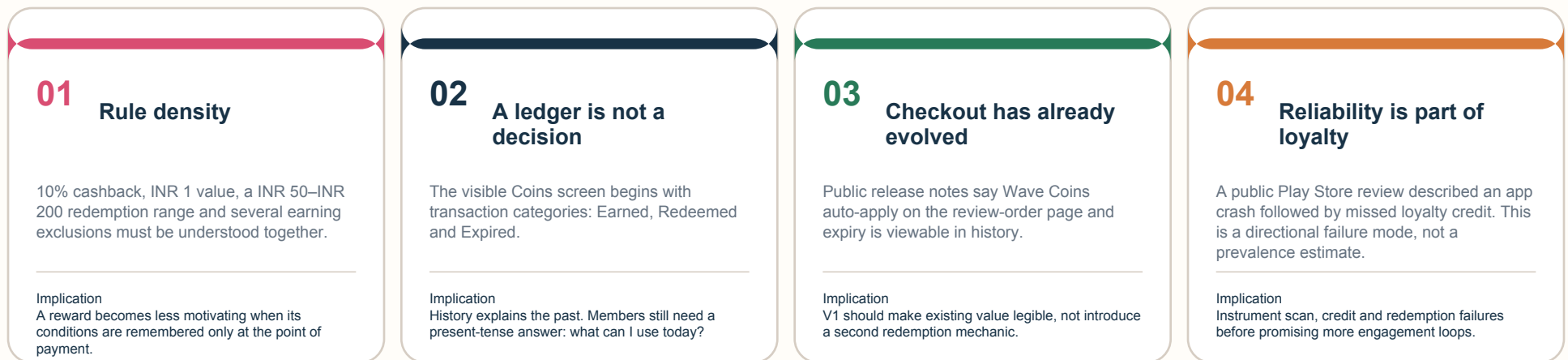
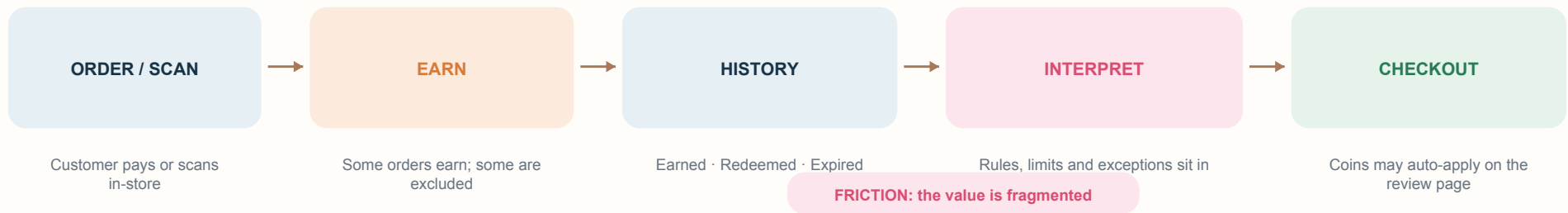
Supplied screens show a transaction-led Coin entry point beside offers, menu, QR payment and store discovery.

Sources: Third Wave Coffee App FAQ (accessed 24 Aug 2026); supplied screenshots IMG_6720–IMG_6724. This is an independent portfolio case study, not an internal company plan.

The problem is not earning coins. It is knowing what they mean in time to use them.

The public rules are clear when read in full; the product journey makes users assemble them across history, FAQ, checkout and in-store payment.

OBSERVED JOURNEY



CORE PROBLEM

App and in-store members with eligible Wave Coins struggle to turn accumulated value into a confident next action because balance, eligibility, expiry and redemption context are distributed across separate surfaces. The result is delayed or missed redemption, avoidable support demand and a weaker reason to return.

The loyalty member is not a demographic. They are a decision-maker at the point of payment.

A behavior-led definition keeps the product focused on the moment loyalty either feels useful or becomes background noise.

PRIMARY BEHAVIOR

The threshold-aware repeat visitor

CONTEXT	Uses the app to order, pay in-store or both; has earned, or expects to earn, Wave Coins.
TRIGGER	Sees a balance, approaches checkout, or learns that an order did not credit.
GOAL	Understand value immediately and decide whether to redeem, save or fix a missed credit.
WORKAROUND	Searches FAQs, asks cafe staff, abandons the question, or waits until another visit.
SUCCESS	Can explain the balance and take the next action in one glance.

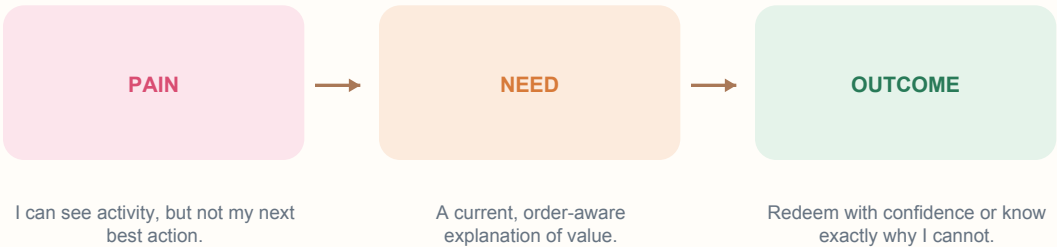
PM DECISION

Do not design a generic rewards dashboard. Design for the two temporal moments that change behavior: before payment and when redemption becomes possible.

JTBD

When I am about to pay or have just earned Wave Coins, I want to know what is usable, what is excluded and what is expiring, so I can get the intended value without a rule search or an awkward counter conversation.

NEED MAP

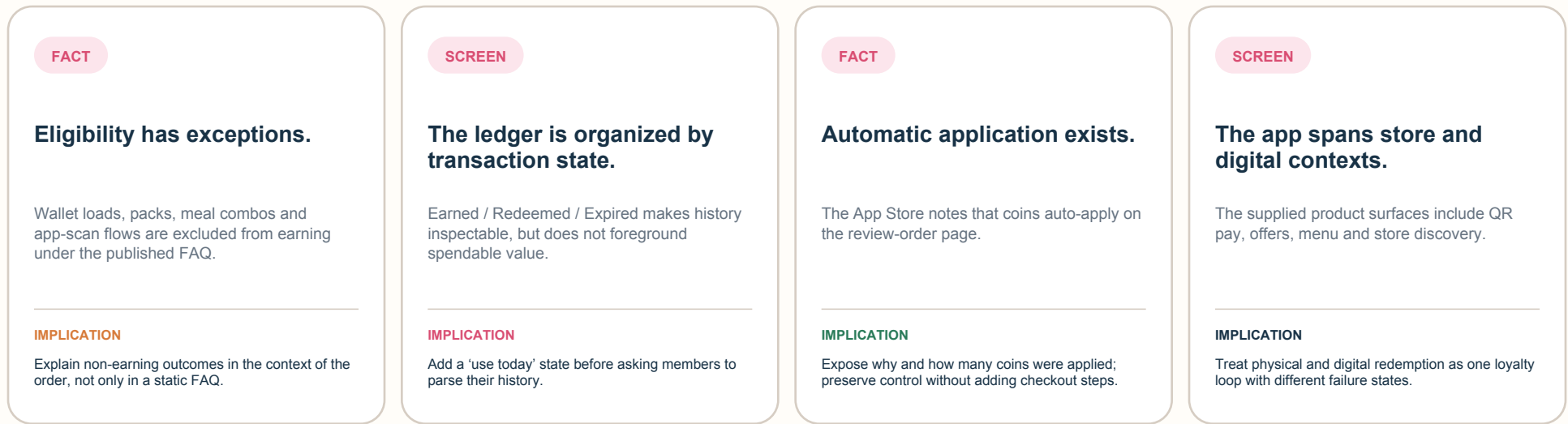


Secondary actor: the in-store payer. Their make-or-break moment comes before payment: “Did the QR scan register, and will this order credit my account?”

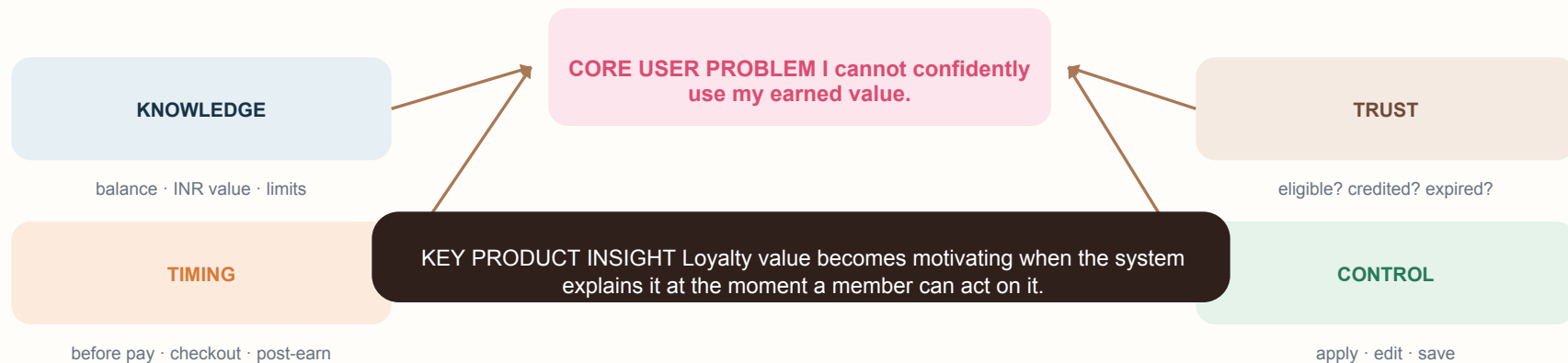
Sources: supplied screens and public Wave Coins rules. Persona is behavior-based and illustrative; no private customer data or fabricated interview quotes are used.

The opportunity is to make coin value legible at every eligible moment, not louder everywhere.

Four public-product signals point to a clarity and reliability problem. They do not quantify prevalence; they shape the MVP hypothesis.



OPPORTUNITY MAP



Coin Clarity makes every loyalty state answerable in one glance.

A lightweight visibility and explanation layer across the wallet, checkout and in-store scan moment.

PRODUCT HYPOTHESIS

We believe that showing a member's usable balance, current eligibility, expiry and applied-discount state will increase confident redemption and return behavior. We will know when 30-day redemption rises without degrading checkout reliability or order economics.

PRODUCT PRINCIPLES

Present tense

Answer what is available now, not only what happened before.

Explain exceptions

Show why an order did not earn or cannot redeem in context.

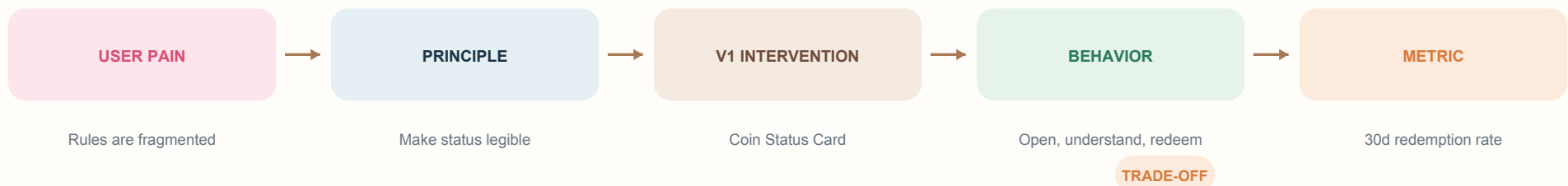
Trust the member

Auto-apply value, then make the calculation editable and visible.

Recover failures

Confirm scan, credit and redemption states; never make staff the system of record.

INTERVENTION CHAIN



CONCEPT FRAME

A compact status card

Placed on Coins home; resurfaced after an eligible earn event.



V1 does not change earn rates, thresholds, tiers or offers. It tests whether clearer existing value can move behavior before the program becomes more generous or more complex.

The MVP is a clarity layer, not a loyalty-program redesign.

Scores are illustrative, based on the case hypothesis. They are deliberately not presented as internal forecasts.

RICE, ILLUSTRATIVE

OPPORTUNITY	REACH	IMPACT	CONF.	EFFORT	RICE	DECISION
Checkout clarity state	18	3	0.80	2	21.6	MUST
Coin status card	20	3	0.65	3	13.0	MUST
In-store scan confirmation	14	2	0.55	3	5.1	MUST
Expiry-rescue nudge	10	2	0.40	3	2.7	NEXT
Variable earn boosters	12	2	0.30	5	1.4	NOT NOW

RICE = Reach × Impact × Confidence ÷ Effort. Relative units, not forecasted revenue.

MVP · MUST SHIP

- Use-today coin status
- Applied / not-applicable checkout explanation
- In-store scan confirmation
- Earn-receipt explanation

NEXT

- Expiry-rescue reminder
- Saved redemption preference
- Order-history filters

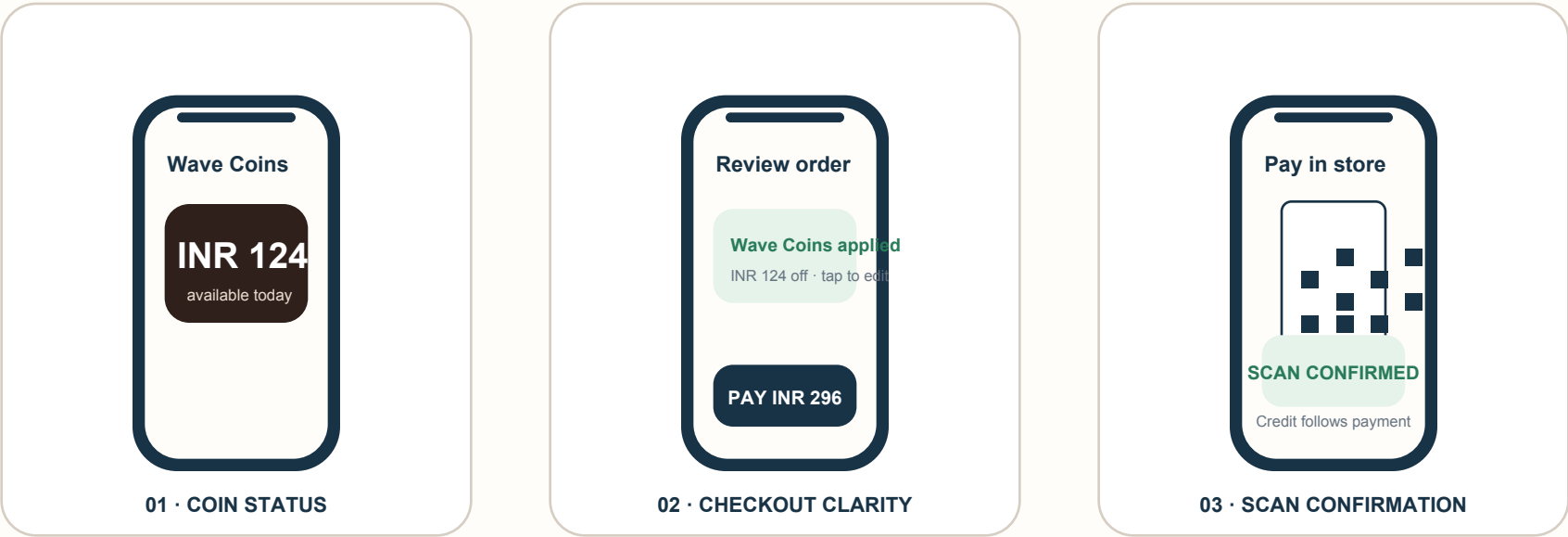
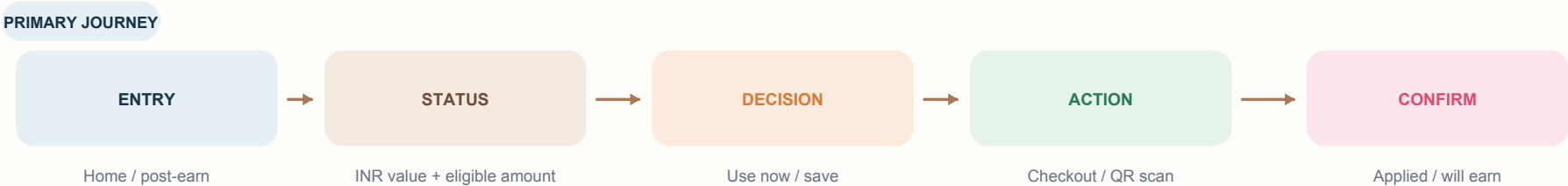
NOT NOW

- Changing earn economics
- New loyalty tiers
- Coin gifting or transfers
- Cross-channel points

Prioritization is a case-study model. Internal reach, impact, confidence and engineering-cost data were not available; each score must be validated with product, engineering and finance partners.

Give members an answer before they need to ask a question.

The flow adds clarity to existing earning and redemption moments. Conceptual frames communicate product logic, not final UI.



RECOVERY PATHS	Why this exists: turns a history surface into a current decision surface.	What the system does: explains applied value or a reason it cannot apply.	What happens next: confirms eligibility before payment and credit after it.
	< INR 50 balance · Explain threshold and show progress, do not present a disabled mystery CTA.	Excluded item · Explain in the order summary why coins were not earned or cannot be used.	Coins expired · Show expiry date and amount in the ledger; never silently remove value.
		QR / network failure · Show scan status, retry safely and create a support-visible event ID.	

A clear member promise requires clear system states.

The V1 requirements below are deliberately narrow: current value, checkout explanation and in-store confidence.

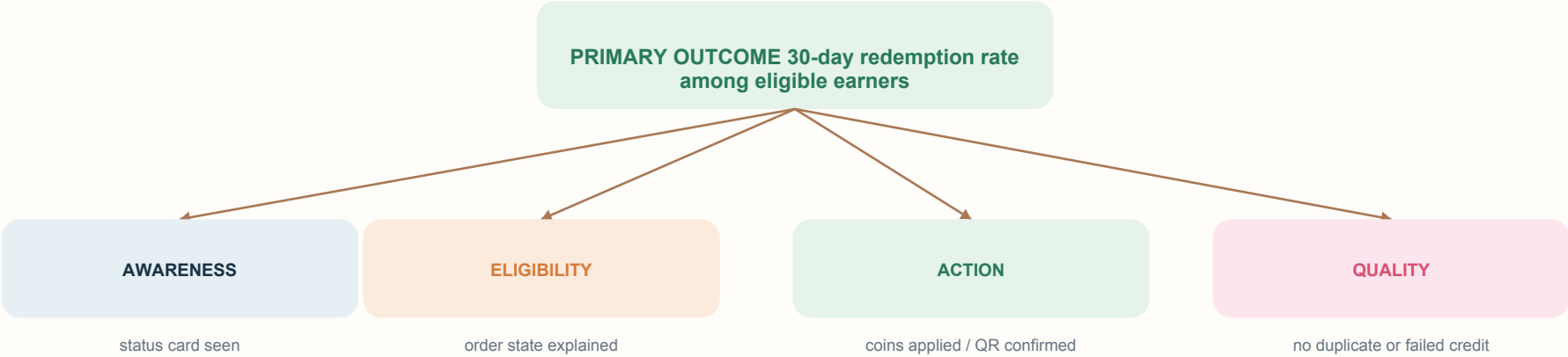
V1 PRD			
ID	USER STORY	REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA
CC-01	As a member, I want to see my usable Coin balance so I can decide whether to redeem.	Render available coins, INR equivalent and nearest expiry on the Coins home.	Given a balance exists, when Coins opens, then balance and INR value appear without requiring a history tab.
CC-02	As a member, I want to know why an order did not earn Coins.	Show an order-level earn receipt with eligible / not eligible state and a concise reason.	Given an excluded category, when payment succeeds, then receipt explains the exclusion and links to the applicable rule.
CC-03	As a member, I want to understand applied Coins before I pay.	At review order, show amount applied, payable total and edit state; preserve current auto-apply behavior where eligible.	Given coins are applied, when review order loads, then discount and updated total are visible and accessible.
CC-04	As an in-store payer, I want confirmation that my app scan was recognized.	After QR read, show scan-confirmed / failed / retry states before payment.	Given a scan error, when retry is selected, then the same order cannot earn duplicate credit.
CC-05	As support, I need traceability for loyalty failures.	Emit durable events for scan, earn calculation, expiry view, redemption and failure reason.	Given a failure, when an event is logged, then support can locate an anonymized event ID and state.
ACCESSIBILITY			
Currency is announced as rupees; color is never the only state signal; touch targets meet platform guidance; screen-reader labels explain discount changes.			
ERROR + EMPTY			
No Coins, < INR 50, excluded order, expired balance, scan failure, payment retry, service unavailability and duplicate scan are explicit states.			
ANALYTICS			
coin_hub_viewed · earn_receipt_viewed · checkout_coin_state_seen · coin_redemption_applied · qr_scan_status · coin_error_seen			

Requirements are a proposed V1. Technical design, eligibility rules, privacy review and service-level behavior require validation with engineering, operations and legal/compliance partners.

Measure a loyalty loop, not a screen interaction.

No internal baseline was supplied. Every target below is illustrative and should be recalibrated from cohort data before launch.

METRIC TREE



MEASUREMENT PLAN

METRIC	BASELINE	ILLUSTRATIVE TARGET	WHY IT MATTERS
30-day redemption rate	Not supplied	+15% relative vs. control	Primary evidence that clearer existing value changes behavior.
Eligible checkout clarity	Not supplied	≥95% explanation rendered	Confirms the service presents a usable state when it should.
Coin-credit error rate	Not supplied	<0.3% of eligible orders	Guardrail against the failure that harms trust most.
Order value after redemption	Not supplied	No material negative shift	Business guardrail; analyze by cohort, not a single average.

LAUNCH EXPERIMENT			
CONTROL	VARIANT	AUDIENCE	DECISION
Current ledger + checkout	Coin status + contextual explanations	Eligible earners or members holding INR 50+; stratify app / store.	Ship on positive lift, with reliability + economics guardrails held.

Measurement values are illustrative for this portfolio case. Run duration should be driven by a pre-launch power calculation using actual redemption, eligible-order and failure-rate baselines.

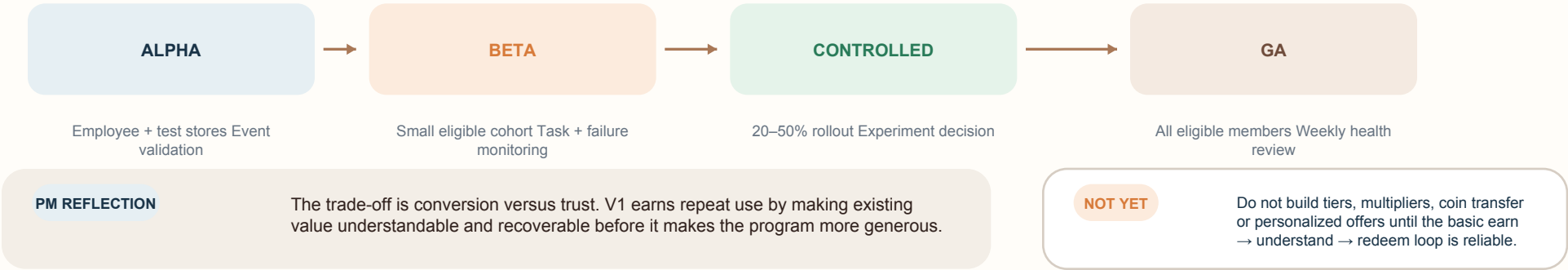
Trust is the feature. The discount is only the proof.

A loyalty system can produce near-term redemption while damaging the relationship if its rules, failures or economics feel arbitrary.

RISK REGISTER

RISK	PROB.	IMPACT	MITIGATION / OWNER
Eligibility logic disagrees across channels	Med	High	One policy service; order-level explanation; event reconciliation. Engineering + finance.
QR or app failure causes missed credit	Med	High	Pre-payment status, idempotent retry, support event ID and daily exception monitoring. Engineering + ops.
More redemption erodes margin	Med	Med	Cohort-level contribution analysis; cap and policy controls remain unchanged in V1. Finance + product.
Notifications feel coercive near expiry	Low	Med	Opt-in preference, frequency cap and factual copy. CRM + product.
New screen increases checkout cognitive load	Med	Med	Keep the default action automatic; use progressive disclosure and task testing. Design + product.

RELEASE APPROACH



Sources: Third Wave Coffee App FAQ; Apple App Store and Google Play public listings; supplied product screens. All roadmap, risk and rollout recommendations are independent portfolio proposals.